MODULE 03 · AMBITIOUS ENTREPRENEURSHIP

The Problem Space

Is this a real problem, or just an interesting one?

COURSE PATH

00 01 02 03 04 05 06 07 08 09 10 11 12

COURSE MATERIAL · SCAN NOW

All slides live on GitHub

The newest version, free, no account needed

github.com/BaNburger/
AmbitiousEntrepreneurship

1. **Open the link**
   github.com/BaNburger/AmbitiousEntrepreneurship
2. **Go to modules**
   then 03-problem-space
3. **Click the lecture PDF**
   M03_Lecture_Problem-Space.pdf, download top right

Public course repository of Ambitious Entrepreneurship. The QR code opens github.com/BaNburger/AmbitiousEntrepreneurship.

WHERE WE ARE · THE COURSE

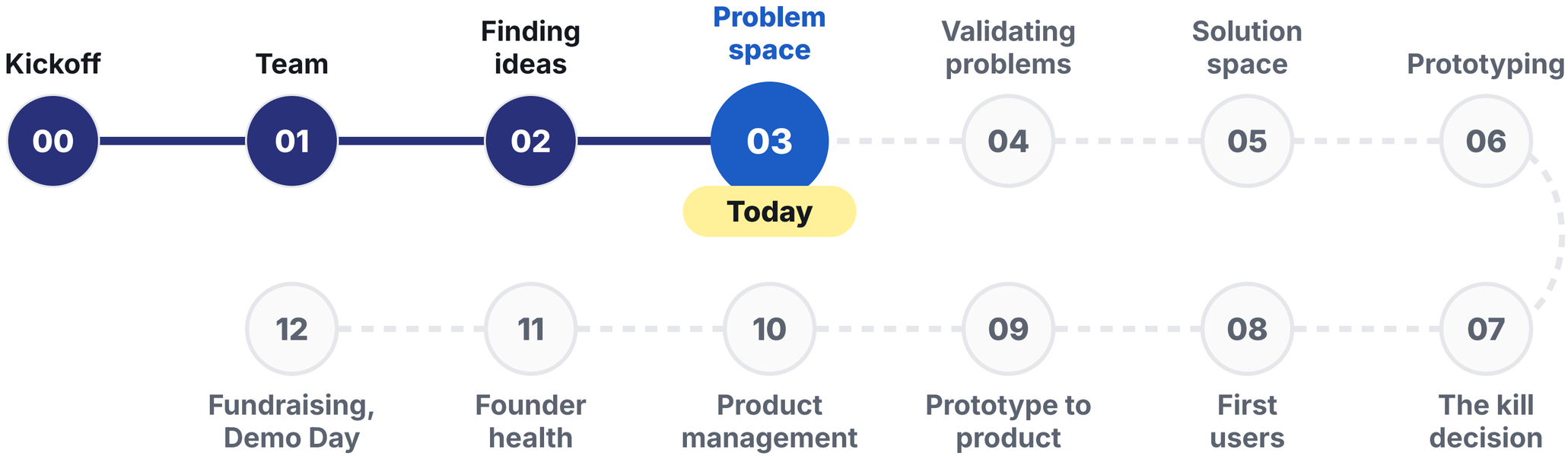
From one idea to a real problem

Thirteen sessions from first idea to first revenue. What teams have by now:

A team that committed
Team (M01)

One idea, picked on evidence
Finding ideas (M02)

Talks with named people
Finding ideas (M02)



CHECK-IN · SHOW OF HANDS

How many problem conversations did you hold since last time?

Hands up for your band. One click on the band per hand

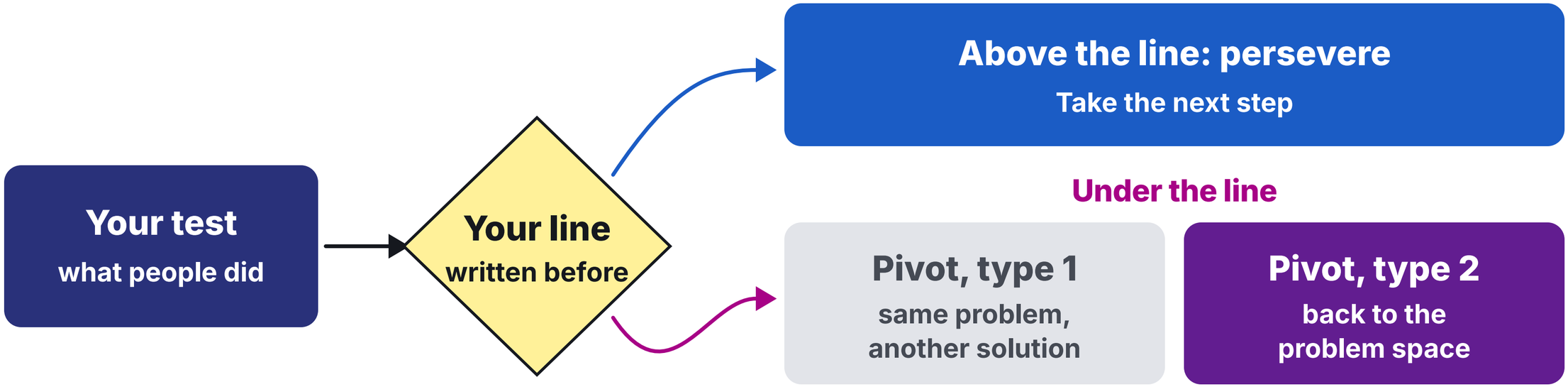
0	1–4	5–14	15+
not yet	started	floor reached	full bar
	under the floor of 5		15 per student

2:00

PIVOT OR PERSEVERE

Under your line? That is a decision, not a failure

Before there is a solution, a pivot goes back to the problem



Both are progress. The only miss: no line, so no decision

FRAMEWORK Pivot or persevere after Ries, E. (2011), The Lean Startup. Pivot types as in the course Glossary.

ACCOUNTABILITY

Report what you did, not what you planned



User interactions?

What did you learn?



New revenue?

Why did they pay?



Shipped?

Why does it matter?

🦄 **Report target vs. actual in small groups**

CHAPTER 1 OF 9

Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship

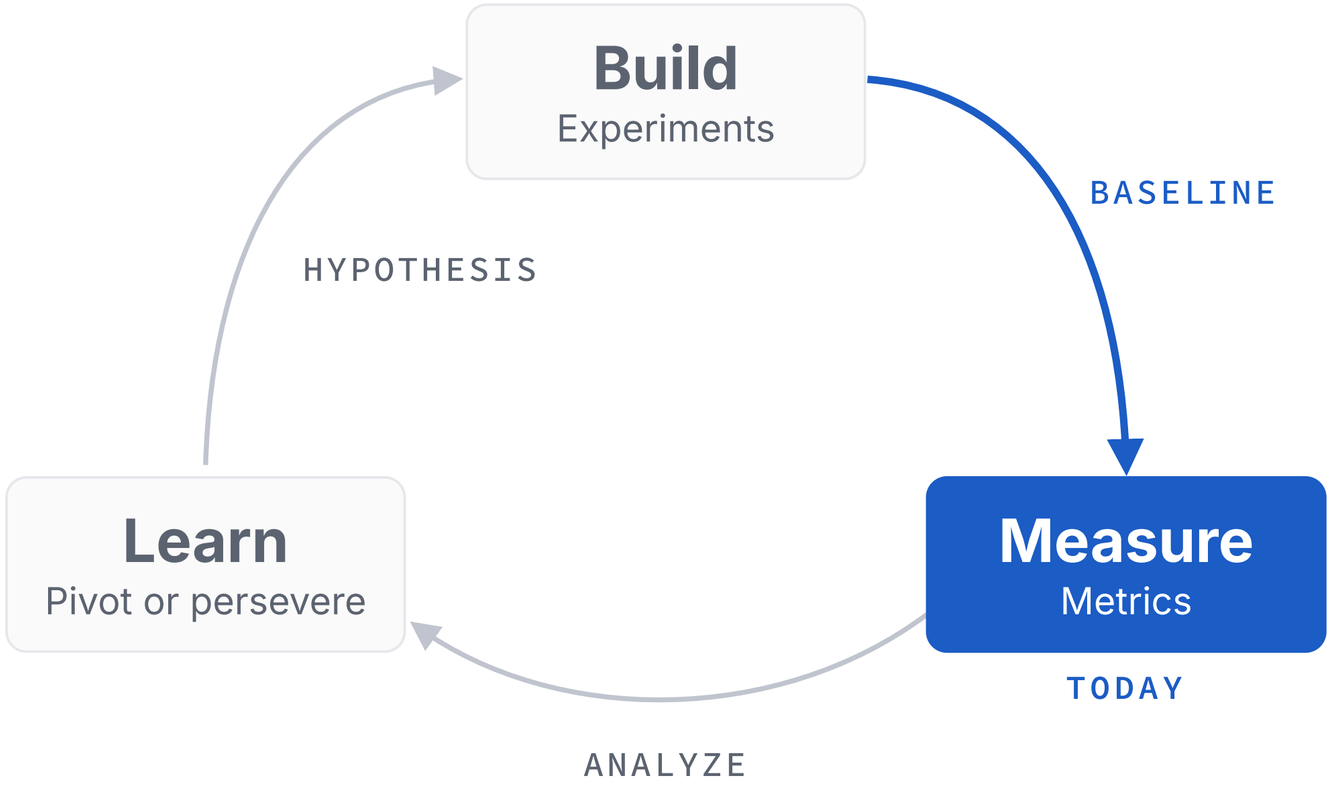
Two pictures from earlier sessions, then we test whether your idea's problem is real.

01 **Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship**
02 Your presentations
03 **Dig it: the problem behind your idea**
04 **Price it: the job and its workaround**
05 **Hear it: conversations about the last time**
06 **Pick it: the segment with its hair on fire**
07 Wrap-up and check-out
08 Workshop: find the pain worth fixing
09 Case discussion

PREVIOUSLY · KICKOFF (M00)

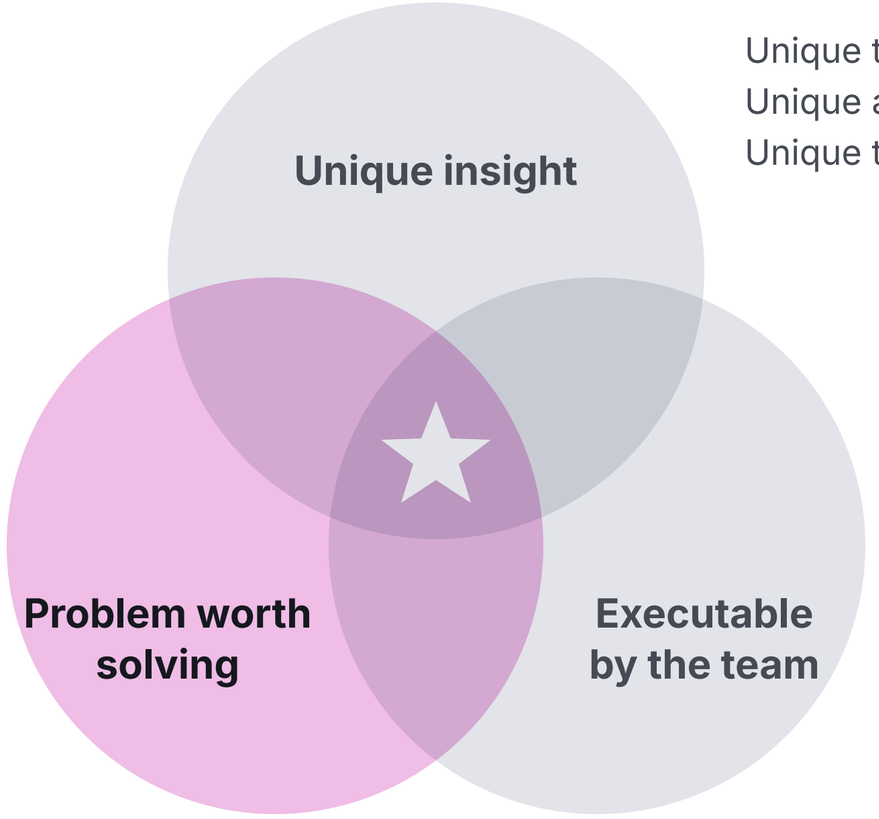
Your idea is a hypothesis

Today you measure the problem



PREVIOUSLY · FINDING IDEAS (M02)

Today we test worth solving



Unique tech
Unique access to customers
Unique take that others don’t have

You are passionate about it
Your audience is passionate about it
You can make a good living from it

You can scale the product
You can scale the backend
You can scale the sales

CHAPTER 2 OF 9

Your presentations

Each team shows in three minutes what it did, learned and needs from us.

01 ~~Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship~~

02 **Your presentations**

03 Dig it: the problem behind your idea

04 Price it: the job and its workaround

05 Hear it: conversations about the last time

06 Pick it: the segment with its hair on fire

07 Wrap-up and check-out

08 Workshop: find the pain worth fixing

09 Case discussion

YOUR PRESENTATIONS · MAKE IT CREDIBLE

Show us where you're at in 3 minutes or less!

3:00

Facts

Statistics or research

Research on the problem, with sources

12 Numbers

Usage or surveys

Conversations per student, ideas dropped

Quotes

Interviews

The three that decided it

Images

Screenshots or users

Your Ideas sheet, heard or assumed

Verdict: kept or dropped at the kill line. Hypothesis: your pitch in one to three sentences

What did you do? **What did you learn?** **How can we help?**

INPUT 1 OF 4 · CHAPTER 3 OF 9

Dig it: the problem behind your idea

Describe the problem without your product, then dig until you reach the root cause.

01 ~~Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship~~

02 ~~Your presentations~~

03 **Dig it: the problem behind your idea**

04 **Price it: the job and its workaround**

05 **Hear it: conversations about the last time**

06 **Pick it: the segment with its hair on fire**

07 Wrap-up and check-out

08 Workshop: find the pain worth fixing

09 Case discussion

INPUT 1 OF 4 · DIG IT · THREE QUESTIONS

Before you build: what is the problem?

1

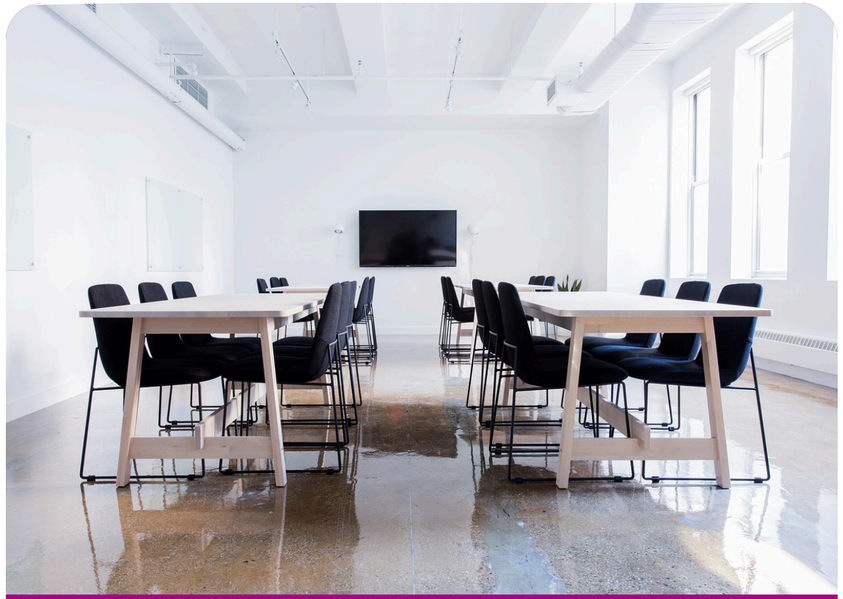
Why start with the problem, not the product?

2

How do you describe a problem without your product?

3

How do you find its root cause?



WHY IT MATTERS

Money runs out last. Poor fit often broke first

CB Insights

Ran out of capital · the final cause

70%

Poor product-market fit · most common root cause

43%

Bad timing

29%

0% 50% 100%

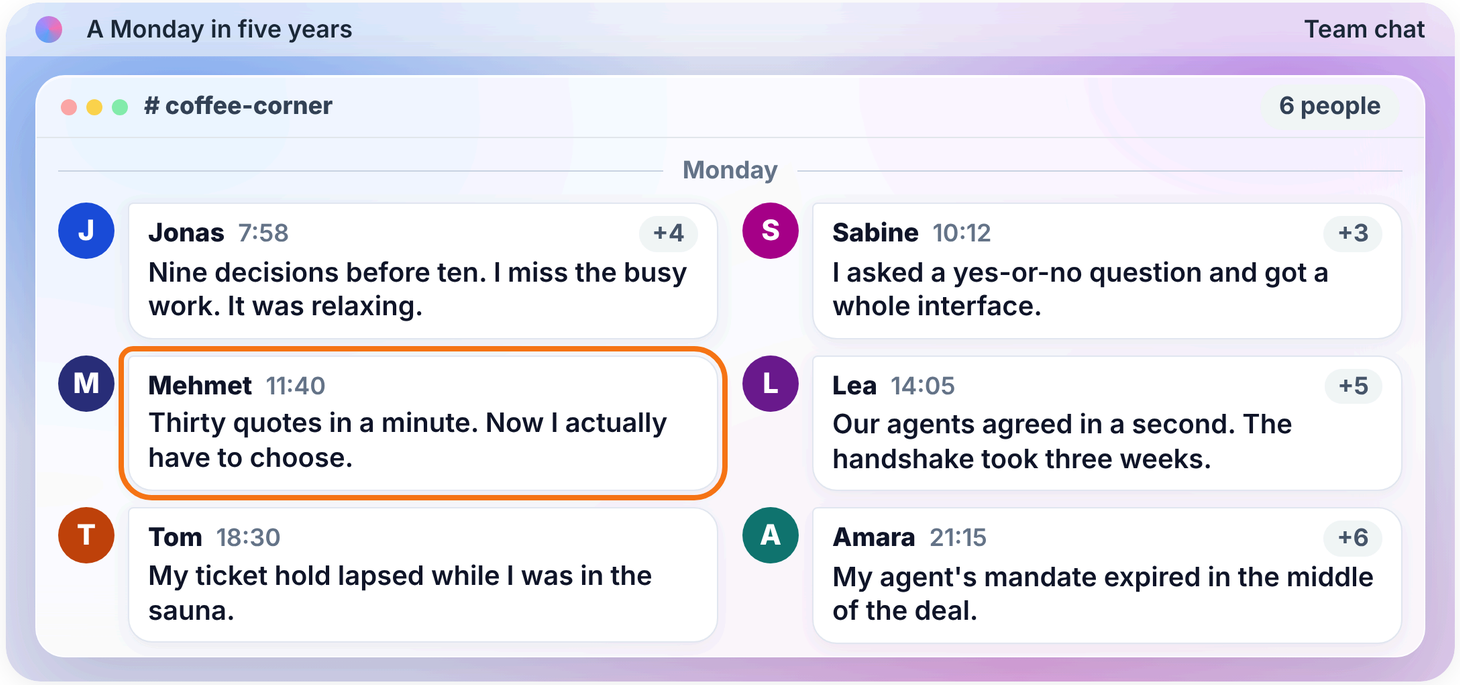
% of 385 shutdowns that name the reason

DATA CB Insights, The top 9 reasons startups fail, 5 March 2026. 385 VC-backed shutdowns since 2023 with known reasons, several reasons each. Bars to scale. Photo: Pexels on Pixabay.

A DAY IN FIVE YEARS · SCENARIO

In five years, we complain about new things. Who has them today?

Each complaint is a problem someone will have. Find the people who have it today



> "Thirty quotes in a minute. Now I actually have to choose."

↓

PROBLEM

Buyers struggle with choosing among dozens of quotes

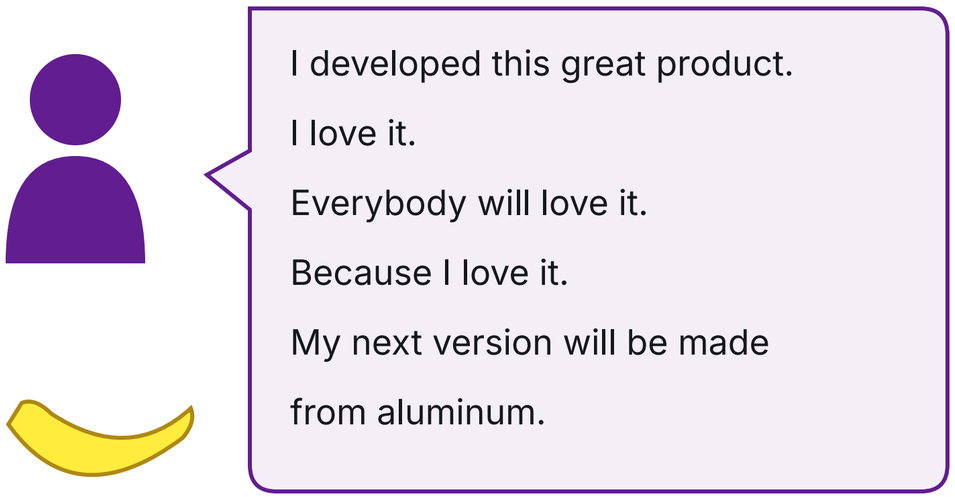
↓

Who has it today? Buyers who already compare dozens of bids. Call them

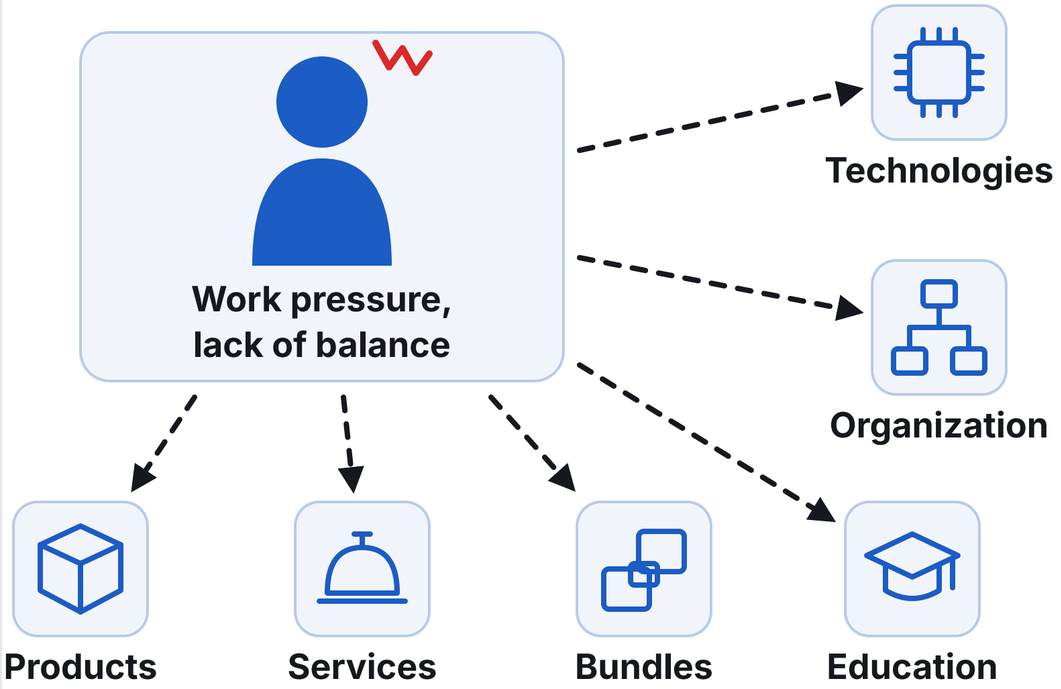
CORNERSTONE · PROBLEM ORIENTED

Love the problem, not your product

Solution oriented



Problem oriented



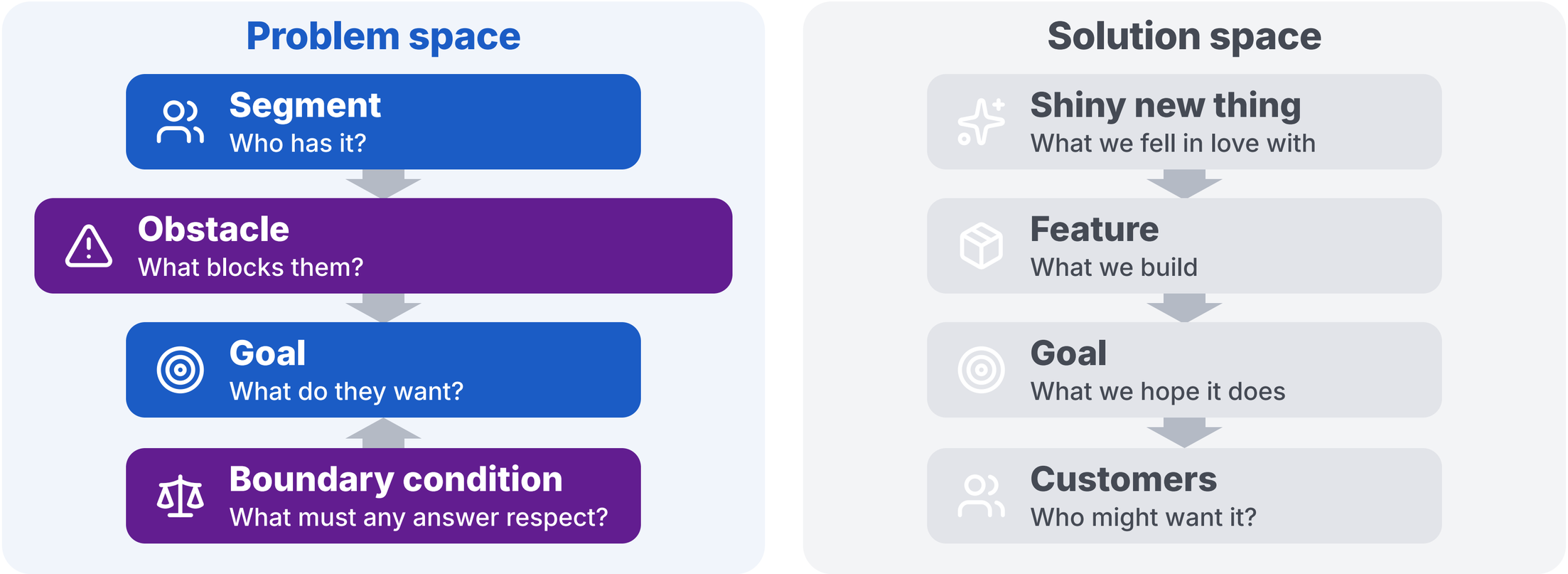
Start with a problem. Then look for solutions.

The other way round is a solution in search of a problem.

YC After Friedman, J. (2020). How to get startup ideas. YC Startup Library, recorded for Startup School 2020. "A solution in search of a problem" is his term.

CORNERSTONE · PROBLEM SPACE VS. SOLUTION SPACE

Start left. Solutions come last



EXAMPLE · PHYSICIANS AND THEIR NOTES

Their problem, with no product in it



Segment Physicians with a full clinic day

Obstacle Every visit leaves a note to write

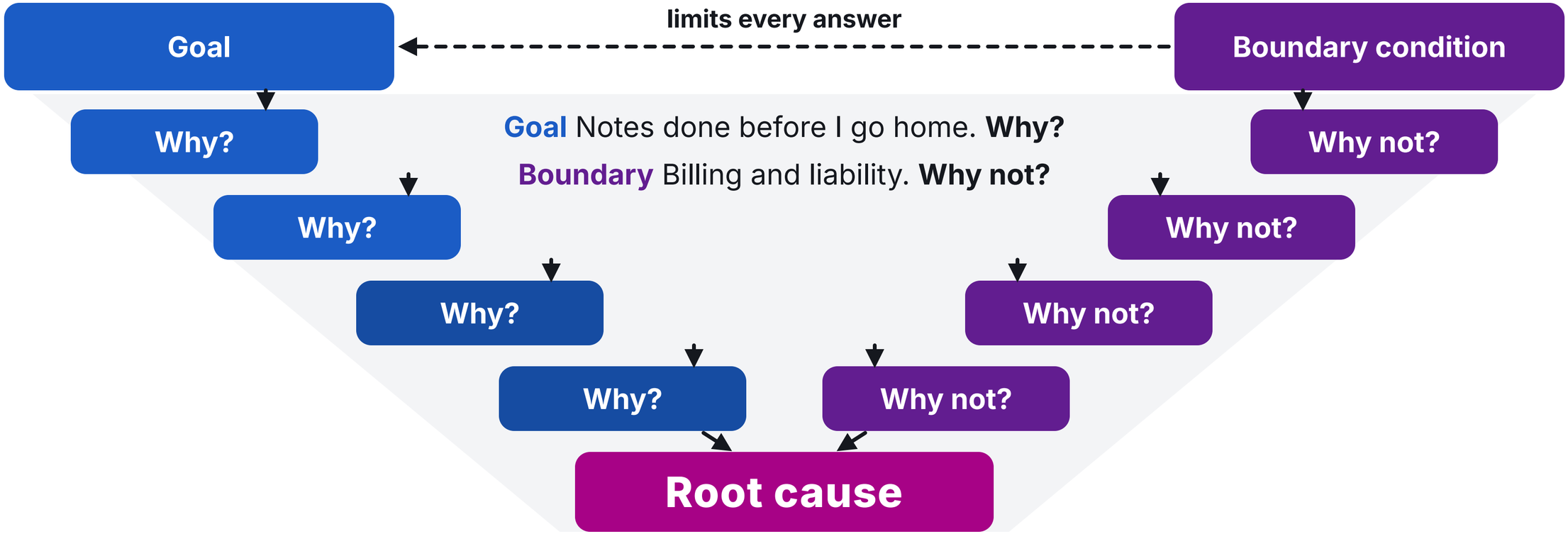
Goal Home on time, notes done

Boundary Each note must hold up for billing and liability

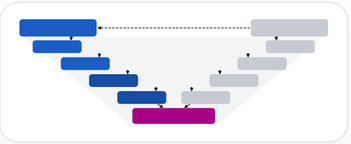
ILLUSTRATIVE Written for this course, from the physicians' day in Sinsky et al. (2016). Photo: Maximilianovich on Pixabay.

CORNERSTONE · FINDING ROOT CAUSES

Ask why. Then ask why not



FRAMEWORK 5 Whys after Ohno, T. (1988). *Toyota Production System*. Critique: Card, A. J. (2017). BMJ Quality & Safety. The physicians' example is Illustrative.



EXAMPLE · PHYSICIANS AND THEIR NOTES

The scribe is a solution. Dig

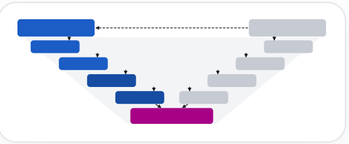
An AI scribe writes the visit note

Every visit leaves a note to type

Half of the office day goes to screen and desk

Notes serve billing and liability first

ILLUSTRATIVE Digging made up for this course. The half is 49% in Sinsky et al. (2016).



EXAMPLE · PHYSICIANS AND THEIR NOTES

Fix the root, not the symptom

Symptom · Notes still open at 9 pm

	Solution	First feature
1st why No time between patients	**Longer slots**	Note time in the schedule
2nd why Each note takes about 10 minutes	**Templates, dictation**	A template per visit type
3rd why They retype what was said in the room	**AI scribe**	Records and drafts the note
Root cause Notes serve billing and liability first	**Shorter note rules**	Codes the visit for billing

Why not just write less? The rules

ILLUSTRATIVE Whys, solutions and features made up for this course. About 10 minutes per note: Duggan et al. (2025).



NOW YOU · ALONE · 4 MINUTES

Your problem space. No product words

Segment	Who has it worst?
Obstacle	What is in the way?
Goal	What do they want?
Boundary	What must any answer respect?
Why? ×3	Why does the obstacle exist?

4:00

OUTPUT

Four lines and a root cause

INPUT 1 OF 4 · DIG IT · THE ANSWERS

Dig it: the root, not the symptom

1

Why start with the problem, not the product?

Money runs out last. Poor fit, the most common root cause, often broke first

2

How do you describe a problem without your product?

Segment, obstacle, goal and boundary, with no product words

3

How do you find its root cause?

Ask why, then why not, until you reach the root, not the symptom

INPUT 2 OF 4 · CHAPTER 4 OF 9

Price it: the job and its workaround

Find the job people hire a product for and put a price on today's workaround.

01 ~~Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship~~

02 ~~Your presentations~~

03 ~~Dig it: the problem behind your idea~~

04 **Price it: the job and its workaround**

05 **Hear it: conversations about the last time**

06 **Pick it: the segment with its hair on fire**

07 Wrap-up and check-out

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09 Case discussion

INPUT 2 OF 4 · PRICE IT · THREE QUESTIONS

What does the problem cost today?

1

What do people hire a product for?

2

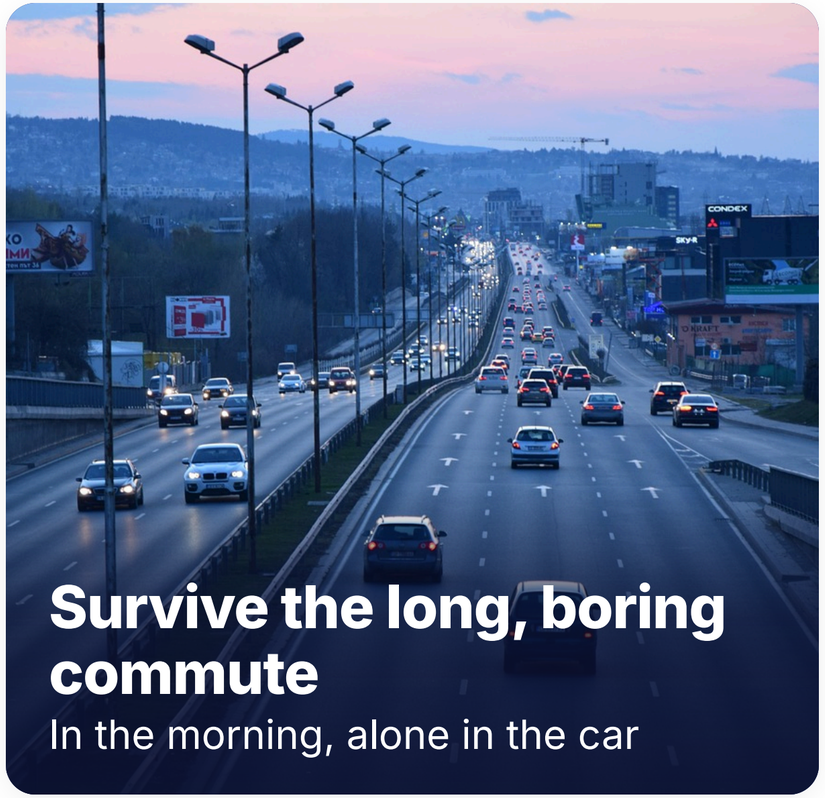
What does the workaround cost them?

3

Why put a number on it?

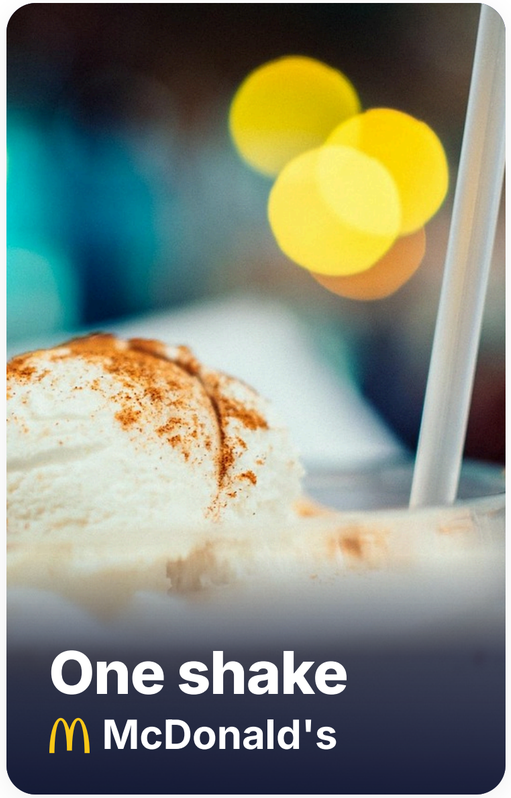
FRAMEWORK · JOBS-TO-BE-DONE · CHRISTENSEN'S EXAMPLE

Same milkshake, two jobs



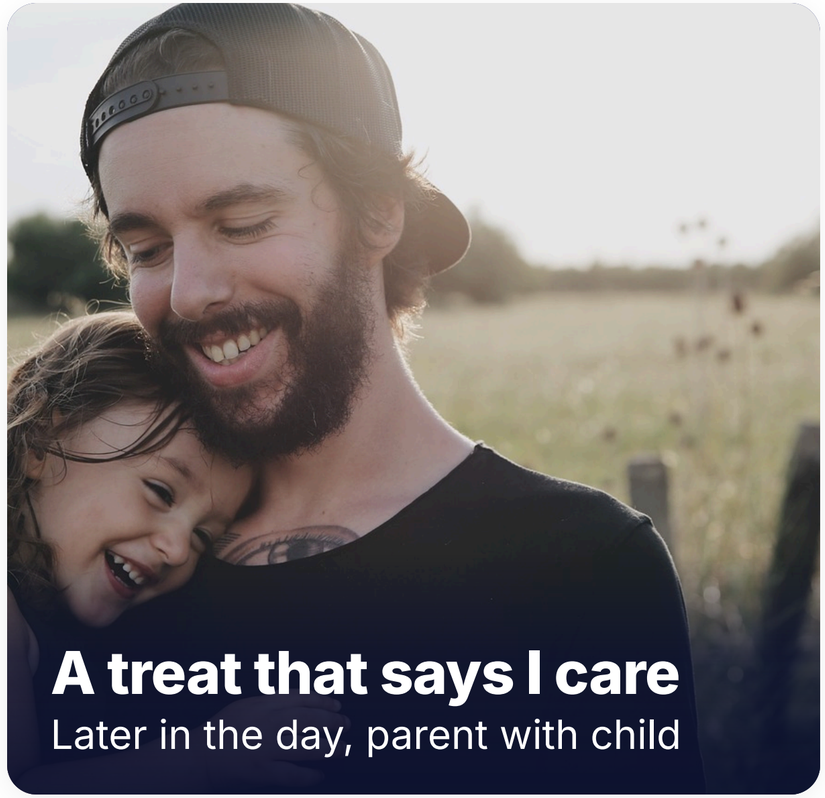
Survive the long, boring commute

In the morning, alone in the car



One shake

McDonald's



A treat that says I care

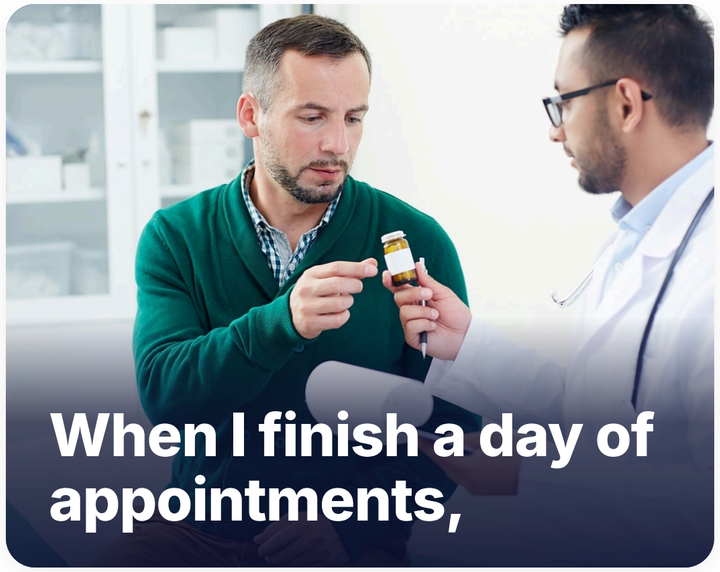
Later in the day, parent with child

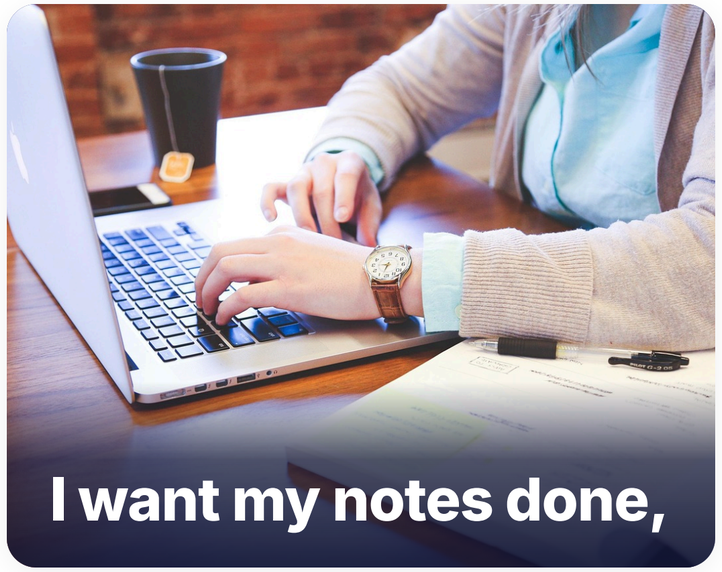
FRAMEWORK Christensen in HBR IdeaCast 554 (2016). Christensen, Cook & Hall (2005), *HBR*. Logos are trademarks of their owners. Photos on Pixabay: zdrsoft, danymena88, StockSnap.

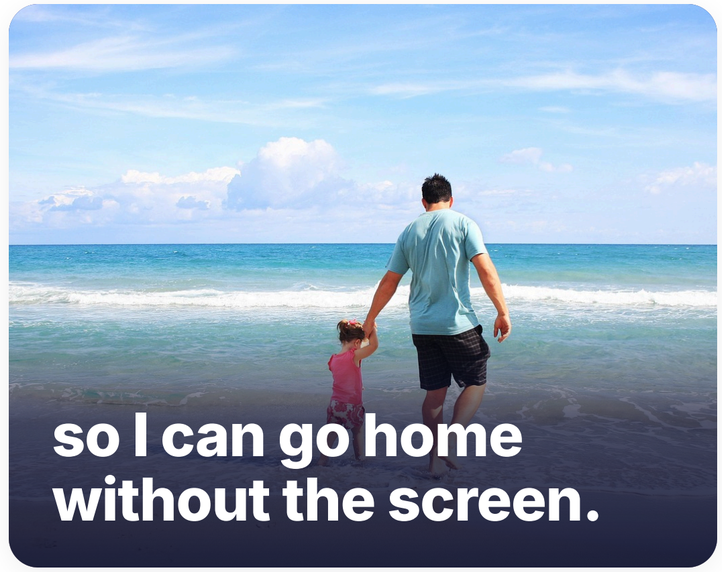
FRAMEWORK · JOBS-TO-BE-DONE

They hire your product for a job

When [situation] → **I want to [motivation]** → **so I can [outcome]**







FRAMEWORK Christensen et al. (2016), *HBR*. The physician's sentence is illustrative. Photos on Pixabay: u_fzv8dg70p8, StartupStockPhotos, sarahbernier3140.



EXAMPLE · PHYSICIANS AND THEIR NOTES

The workaround costs hours. Count them

With patients

27%

Screen and desk work · the workaround

49%

0% 50% 100%

% of the office day, 57 US physicians

+ 1 to 2 hours
every night, self-reported by 21 of them

57
US physicians observed

RESEARCH Sinsky, C., et al. (2016). Allocation of physician time in ambulatory practice. *Annals of Internal Medicine*, 165(11). Bars to scale. Photo: Free-Photos on Pixabay.



EXAMPLE · AN AI SCRIBE, ONE HEALTH SYSTEM

Your workaround's number is what a fix must beat

Note time per appointment · 10.3 min before

8.2 min with the scribe	2.1 min less

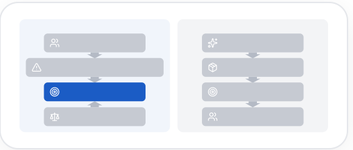
Work after hours, per workday · 50.6 min before

35.4 min with the scribe	15.2 min less

Minutes · each bar is that row's time before the scribe

Abridge A real market, valued at $5.3 billion, in over 300 health systems

RESEARCH Duggan, M. J., et al. (2025). *JAMA Network Open*. One health system, 46 clinicians, 2024, before and after, not randomized. Each bar is that row's time before, to scale. Abridge: Fortune, 11 June 2026. Photo: ovariancancer1 on Pixabay.



NOW YOU · ALONE · 3 MINUTES

Write the job. Price the workaround

When [situation]

I want to [motivation]

so I can [outcome]

It costs how many euros or hours?

3:00

OUTPUT

One sentence, one number. Heard or assumed?

INPUT 2 OF 4 · PRICE IT · THE ANSWERS

Price it: the number a fix must beat

1

What do people hire a product for?

A job: when [situation], I want to [motivation], so I can [outcome]

2

What does the workaround cost them?

Count it in hours or euros, like the physicians' screen and desk time

3

Why put a number on it?

The workaround's number is what a fix must beat

Hear it: conversations about the last time

Ask about the last time it happened, never pitch, and keep their exact words.

01 ~~Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship~~

02 ~~Your presentations~~

03 ~~Dig it: the problem behind your idea~~

04 ~~Price it: the job and its workaround~~

05 **Hear it: conversations about the last time**

06 **Pick it: the segment with its hair on fire**

07 Wrap-up and check-out

08 Workshop: find the pain worth fixing

09 Case discussion

INPUT 3 OF 4 · HEAR IT · THREE QUESTIONS

How do you hear the truth?

1

Why not ask what people would do?

2

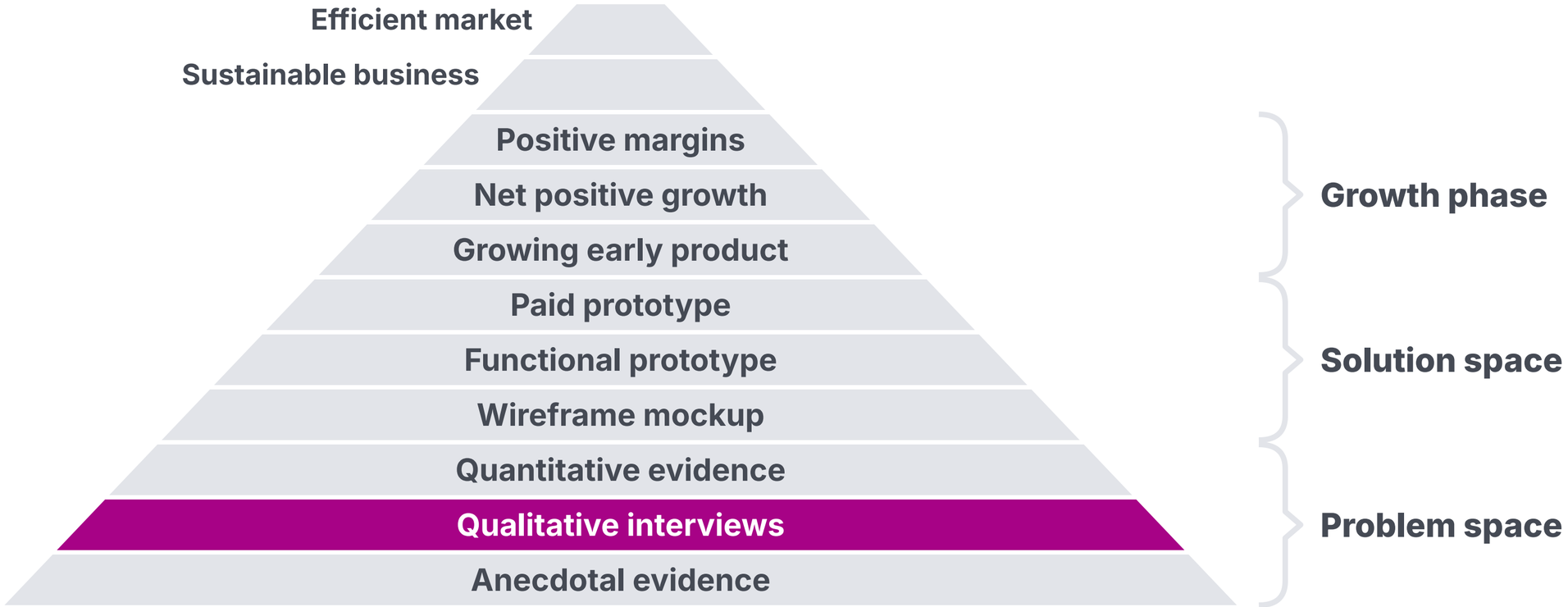
What do you ask instead?

3

How many conversations are enough?

CORNERSTONE · HIERARCHY OF EVIDENCE

From today you stand on rung two





WHY IT MATTERS

What people plan is not what they do



Intentions moved this much · medium to large

Effect size 0.66

Behaviour moved about half as much · small to medium

Effect size 0.36

0 0.33 0.66

Average change as effect size

47 experiments

Randomly assigned, a treatment raised intentions, a control group got none

RESEARCH Webb, T. L., & Sheeran, P. (2006). Does changing behavioral intentions engender behavior change? *Psychological Bulletin*, 132(2). Effect size is Cohen's d, bars to scale. Photo: FitnessStore112 on Pixabay.



PROBLEM CONVERSATIONS · TIP 1 OF 4

Ask about the last time, not in general

FROM

"What do you feel about your notes?"

↓

TO

"What did you feel the last time?"

The Mom Test. Ask about specifics in the past, not opinions about the future

your notetaker · call with Dr. Anna K., GP, own practice

Problem conversation · 31:08

Consent asked at 00:00

Y **You** What do you feel about your notes?

A **Anna** Oh, they're fine. Part of the job.

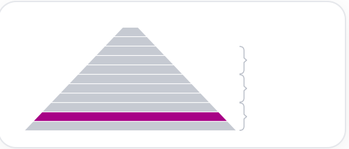
In general · nothing to use

Y **You** What did you feel the last time?

A **Anna** **Last night, 9 pm at the kitchen table, 14 notes still open.** I was furious.

The last time · a story you can use

ILLUSTRATIVE Screen prototyped, Dr. Anna K. made up. Rule from Fitzpatrick (2013), *The Mom Test*. Migicovsky (2019).



PROBLEM CONVERSATIONS · TIP 2 OF 4

Don't lead. Discover

FROM

"Wouldn't an app make that easier?"

↓

TO

"What do you do when it happens?"

The Mom Test. Talk about their life, not your idea

your notetaker · call with Dr. Anna K., GP, own practice

Problem conversation · 31:08 Consent asked at 00:00

Y **You** Wouldn't an app make that easier?

A **Anna** Yes, sure. Sounds great.

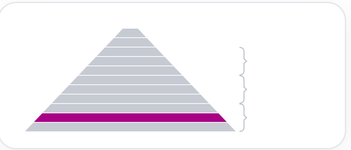
Leading · a polite yes

Y **You** What do you do when it happens?

A **Anna** **I block Sunday mornings to catch up.** My kids know not to ask.

Discovered · a workaround

ILLUSTRATIVE Screen prototyped, Dr. Anna K. made up. Rule from Fitzpatrick (2013), *The Mom Test*.



PROBLEM CONVERSATIONS · TIP 3 OF 4

Never pitch. Listen

FROM

"Will you use our product?"

↓

TO

"How do you solve it today?"

The Mom Test. Talk less, listen more

your notetaker · call with Dr. Anna K., GP, own practice

Problem conversation · 31:08

Consent asked at 00:00

You Will you use our product?

Anna Maybe. Send me a link.

Pitched · you learn nothing

You How do you solve it today?

Anna I dictate on the drive home. **A typist writes it up, 400 euros a month.**

Listened · it already costs money

ILLUSTRATIVE Screen prototyped, Dr. Anna K. made up. Rule from Fitzpatrick (2013), *The Mom Test*. Alströmer (2022).



PROBLEM CONVERSATIONS · TIP 4 OF 4

Record it. Keep their exact words

YOUR SUMMARY

"annoying, wants automation"

THEIR WORDS

"Last night, 9 pm at the kitchen table, 14 notes still open."

The Mom Test. Write down their exact words

Ask first: "May we record this for our team and the course staff, who may spot-check it?"

your notetaker · call with Dr. Anna K., GP, own practice

Problem conversation · 31:08

Consent asked at 00:00

00:00 **You** May we record this for our team and the course staff, who may spot-check it?

00:06 **Anna** Sure, go ahead.

14 minutes later

14:27 **Anna** **Last night, 9 pm at the kitchen table, 14 notes still open.**

Copy quote

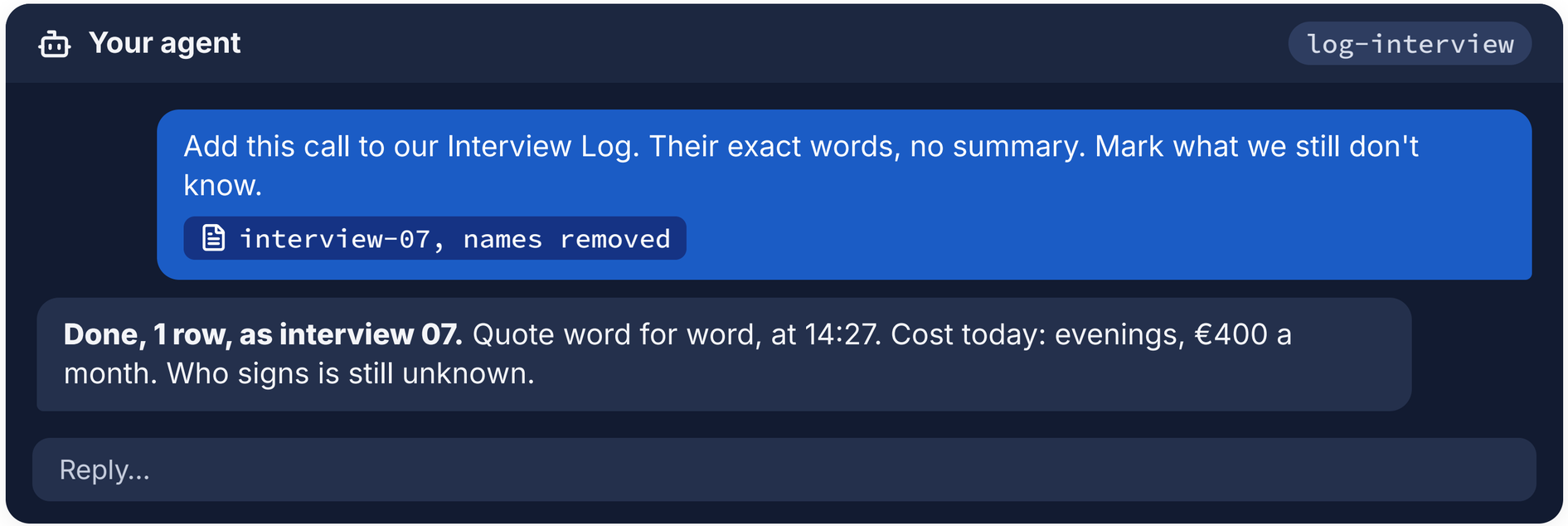
Student Toolkit · Interview Log

Interviewee	Role/Persona	Notable Quote	Cost today
Anna K.	GP, own practice	**"Last night, 9 pm at the kitchen table, 14 notes still open."**	evenings, €400 a month

ILLUSTRATIVE Screen prototyped, quote and people made up. Consent sentence from the course Legal Basics. Rule from Fitzpatrick (2013), *The Mom Test*.

WITH YOUR AGENT

Record it. Keep their exact words



ILLUSTRATIVE Screen prototyped, quote and people made up. Consent sentence from the course Legal Basics. Rule from Fitzpatrick (2013), *The Mom Test*.

FIVE QUESTIONS

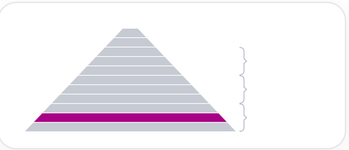
Ask these five, last time first

1. **Tell me about the last time…**
2. **What was the hardest part?**
3. **Why was that hard? Up to 5×**
4. **How do you solve it currently?**
5. **What don't you love about that solution?**



Then: tell me about another time.

YC After Migicovsky (2019), How to talk to users, Startup School, based on Fitzpatrick, R. (2013). *The Mom Test*. Order as in the course workshop. Photo: kaboompics on Pixabay.



NOW YOU · IN PAIRS · 3 MINUTES

Fix your worst question

1. Take the worst question you asked or planned
2. Rewrite it as one of the five
3. Read it to your partner. Leading?

3:00

OUTPUT

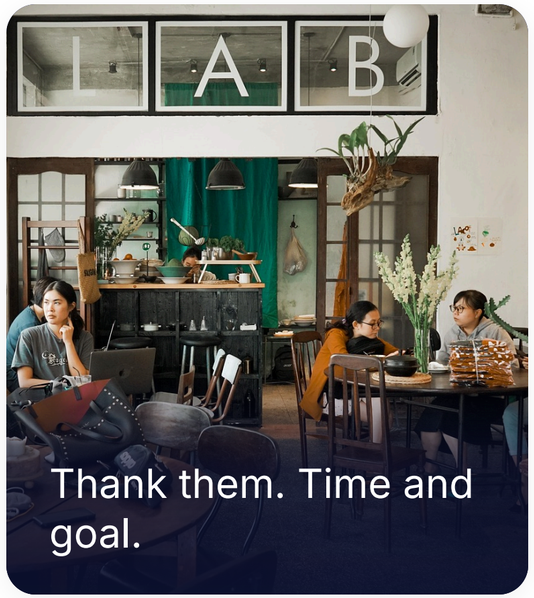
One question you can ask tomorrow

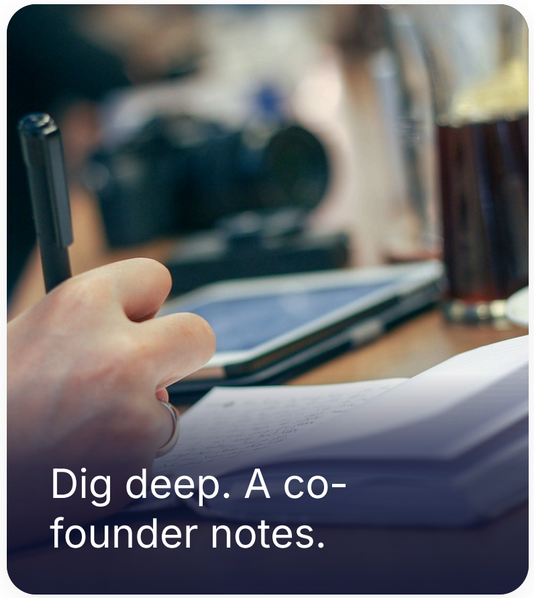
PROCESS · ONE CONVERSATION

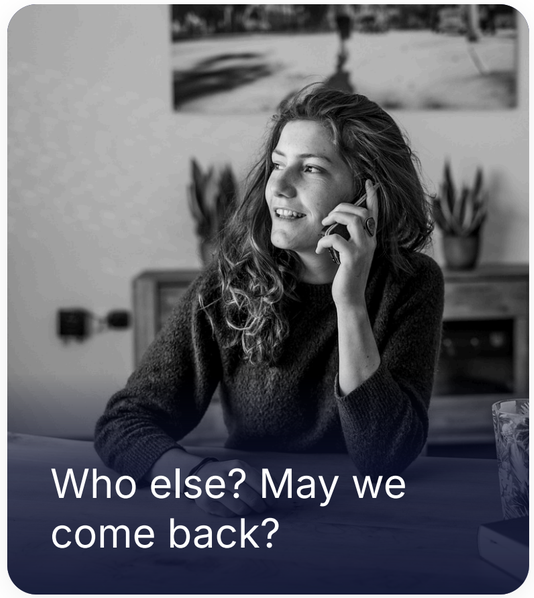
End every conversation with a next step

Gather intel → **Set the stage** → **Interview** → **Follow through**









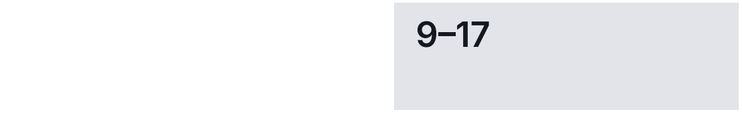
Photos on Pixabay: StartupStockPhotos, uh_yeah_20101995, Pexels, VinzentWeinbeer.



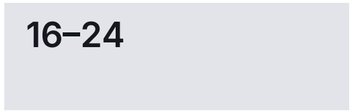
HOW MANY CONVERSATIONS

About 20 per segment

9 to 17 · narrow question, similar people



16 to 24 · to understand why



20 of 30 · found over 90% of the needs



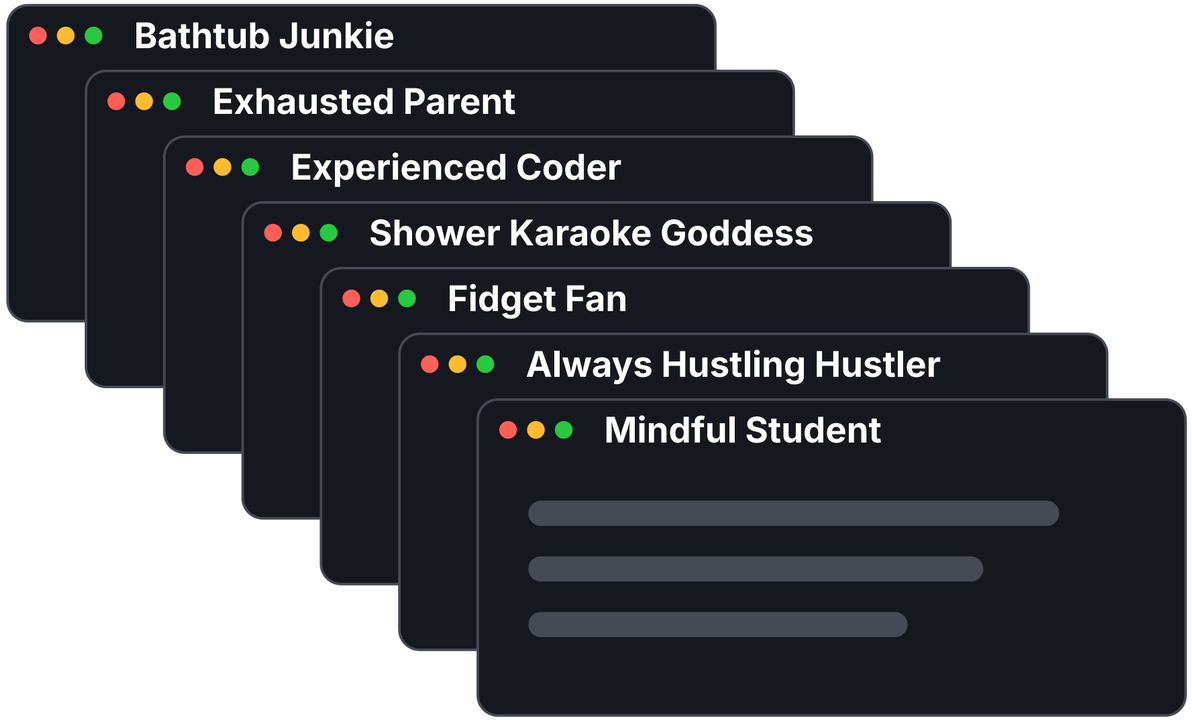
15 each

a team of three holds 45 in one week

RESEARCH Hennink & Kaiser (2022), review of 23 articles. Hennink et al. (2017), 25 interviews. Griffin & Hauser (1993), 30 customers. To scale. Photo: StockSnap on Pixabay.

AI REHEARSAL

Personas are sparring partners, not customers



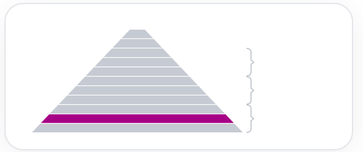
Note

Use AI to understand problems, not to find solutions

AI REHEARSAL · WHY THEY NEVER COUNT

Personas match the average, miss the rest

Persona answers against a real survey



Differed from real people

48%

Flipped the sign · about 1 in 6

15%

0% 50% 100%

% of all persona estimates

Willingness to pay for fluoride toothpaste

Humans

1×

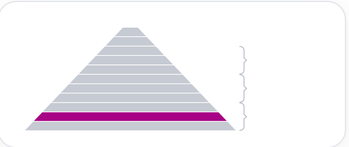
GPT

about 3×

0 1× 2× 3×

Premium, humans = 1×

RESEARCH Bisbee et al. (2024), *Political Analysis*, ChatGPT 3.5 personas against US election surveys, 2016 to 2020. Brand, Israeli & Ngwe (2026), HBS Working Paper 23-062. Each group drawn to scale. The 15% are the 32% of the 48% that flipped.



HOW-TO · REHEARSE WITH AI · STEP 1 OF 4

Open a fresh chat

Your agent temporary chat

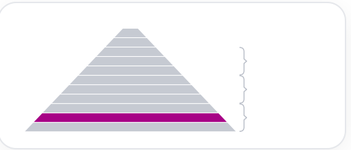
What are you working on?

Nothing from your earlier chats colours this one

Ask anything...

1. **Open a fresh chat**
2. Write the critical-customer skill
3. Let it draft Mom Test questions
4. Rehearse until nobody says yes

Temporary chat: no memory.



HOW-TO · REHEARSE WITH AI · STEP 2 OF 4

Write the critical-customer skill

critical-customer.md `skill`

Role. You are a critical customer in [field], with long experience of competing services.

Steps. Answer from one past event. Challenge my assumptions.

Good. "Last Tuesday I gave up after twenty minutes."

Weak. "Sure, that sounds useful."

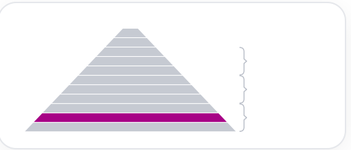
Check. Did the question lead you? Say so. Never compliment.

Saved with your team's work

1. Open a fresh chat
2. **Write the critical-customer skill**
3. Let it draft Mom Test questions
4. Rehearse until nobody says yes

Wrong answer? Fix the skill, not the answer.

ILLUSTRATIVE Skill written for this course from Bastian's critical-customer prompt, examples made up.



HOW-TO · REHEARSE WITH AI · STEP 3 OF 4

Let it draft Mom Test questions

Your agent `critical-customer`

Use the rules of The Mom Test. Draft five questions for physicians and their notes.

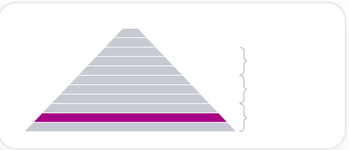
Five questions, all about the past.
1. Tell me about the last time you finished your notes.
2. What was the hardest part?
3. Why was that hard?
4. How do you get them done today?
5. What don't you love about that?

Reply...

1. Open a fresh chat
2. Write the critical-customer skill
3. **Let it draft Mom Test questions**
4. Rehearse until nobody says yes

Compare with our five questions.

ILLUSTRATIVE Chat prototyped for this course, questions in the form of the course's five.



HOW-TO · REHEARSE WITH AI · STEP 4 OF 4 · IN PAIRS

Rehearse until nobody says yes

1. Take the three it drafted, or three of yours
2. Rewrite each about one past event
3. Ask a persona. A yes means leading.

4:00

OUTPUT

Three open questions

INPUT 3 OF 4 · HEAR IT · THE ANSWERS

Hear it: the last time, in their words

1

Why not ask what people would do?

What people plan is not what they do. Behaviour moved half as much

2

What do you ask instead?

About the last time it happened: the five golden questions, never a pitch

3

How many conversations are enough?

About 20 per segment, each ending with a next step

🎯 **15 each**, a team of three holds 45 in one week

Pick it: the segment with its hair on fire

Pick the segment that hurts most, often, and can pay, based on what you heard.

01 ~~Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship~~

02 ~~Your presentations~~

03 ~~Dig it: the problem behind your idea~~

04 ~~Price it: the job and its workaround~~

05 ~~Hear it: conversations about the last time~~

06 **Pick it: the segment with its hair on fire**

07 Wrap-up and check-out

08 Workshop: find the pain worth fixing

09 Case discussion

INPUT 4 OF 4 · PICK IT · THREE QUESTIONS

Whose hair is on fire?

1

What makes a segment worth picking?

2

Who decides, and who pays?

3

What do you base the pick on?

Their hair is on fire. Hand them a brick and they still grab it.

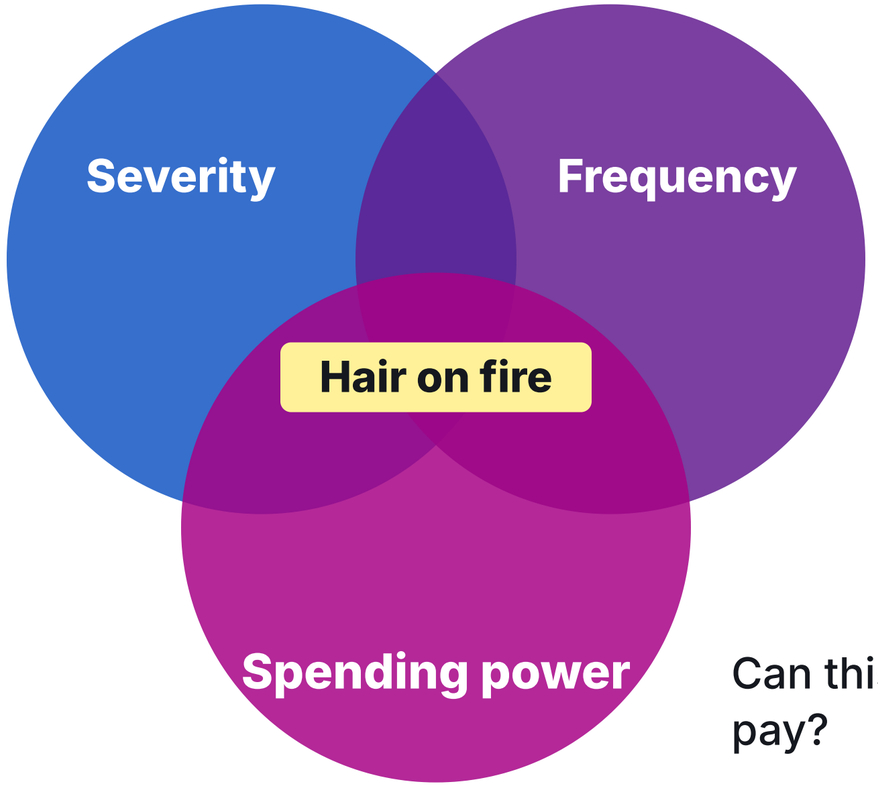
That segment forgives your first version. Start there.

YC After Seibel, M. (2016, June 27). The real product market fit. Y Combinator blog. The brick image is his, crediting Sequoia.

FRAMEWORK · THREE CIRCLES

It hurts, it happens often, they can pay

Money earned or saved?



How often?

Can this person pay?

EXAMPLE · IMPLANTS IN US HOSPITALS

The chooser is not the payer



specifies →

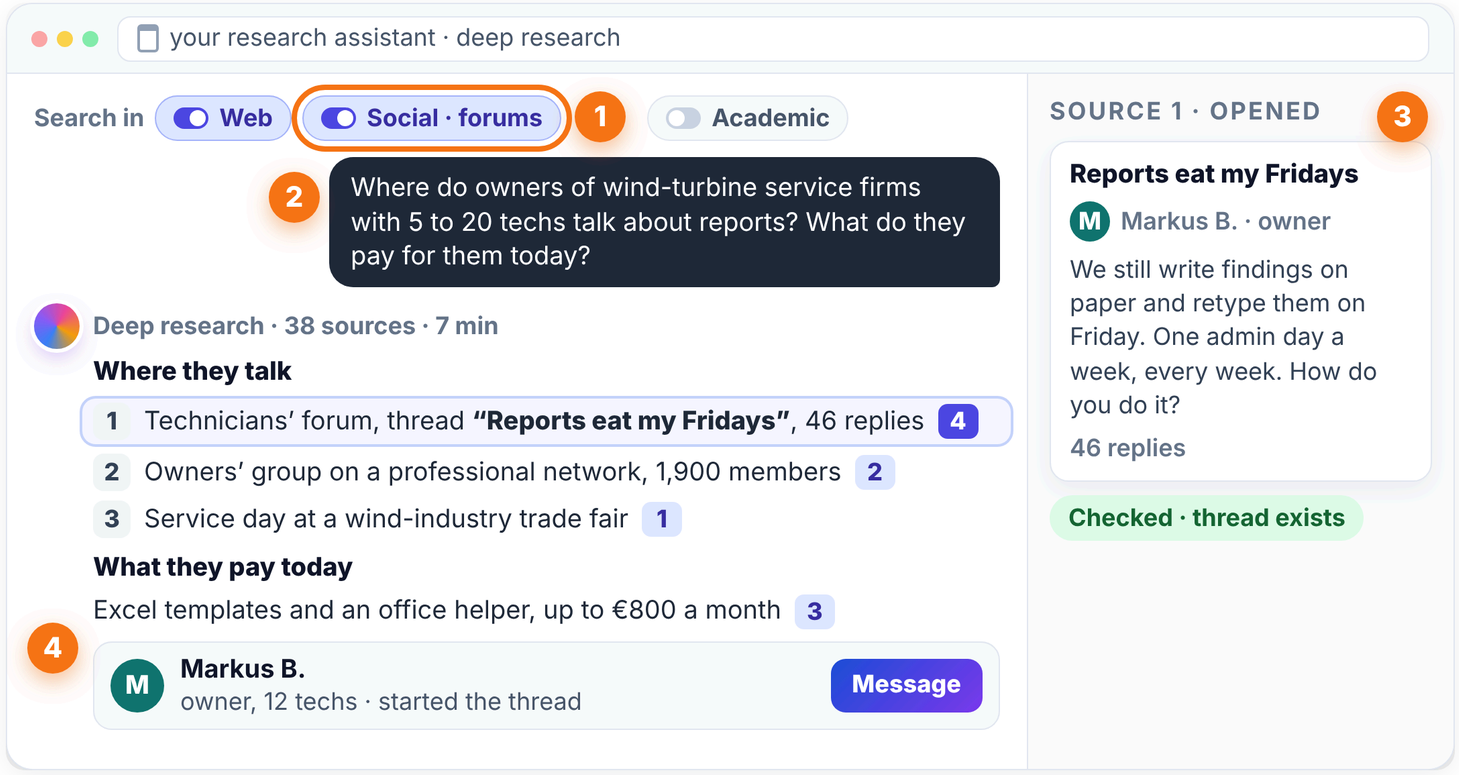


The surgeon pushes for it inside, and the hospital signs. That is a **champion**. More in Finding first users (M08).

RESEARCH Lerner et al. (2008), *Health Affairs*. Burns et al. (2018), *Medical Devices*. Photos on Pixabay: sasint, 12019.

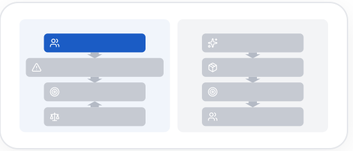
HOW-TO · AI DESK RESEARCH

Let AI find where they talk



1. **Pick sources, Social for forums**
2. **Ask where they talk and pay**
3. **Open every source**
4. **Message a named person**

ILLUSTRATIVE Screen prototyped for this course, forum, people and numbers made up. Deep research in ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini and Perplexity, vendor pages as of October 2026.



YOUR PAIN MAP

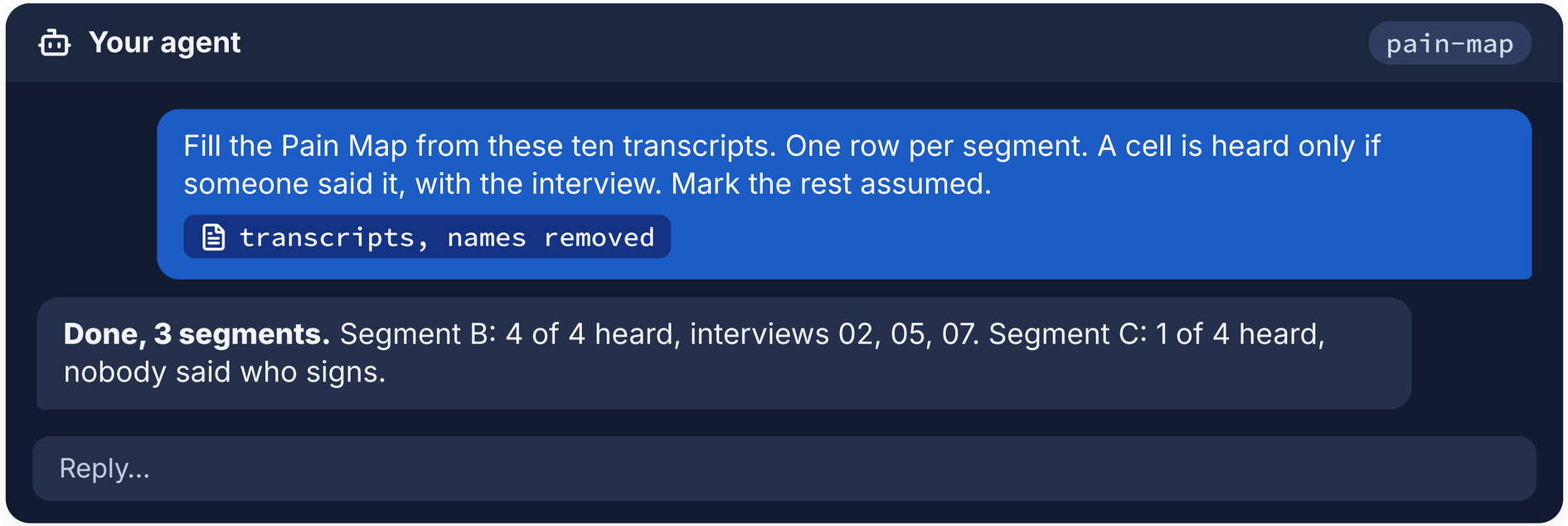
Commit on what you heard

	Frequency How often?	**Intensity** Cost of one time?	**Current spend** Paid today?	**Budget holder** Who signs?
Segment A	● **monthly** heard	○ **30 min** assumed	● **nothing** heard	○ **unclear** assumed
Segment B	● **daily** heard	● **2 hours** heard	● **€200 a month** heard	● **team lead** heard
Segment C	○ **weekly** assumed	● **1 hour** heard	○ **Excel only** assumed	○ **owner** assumed

ILLUSTRATIVE Pain Map columns as in the course workshop. Segments and values made up.

WITH YOUR AGENT

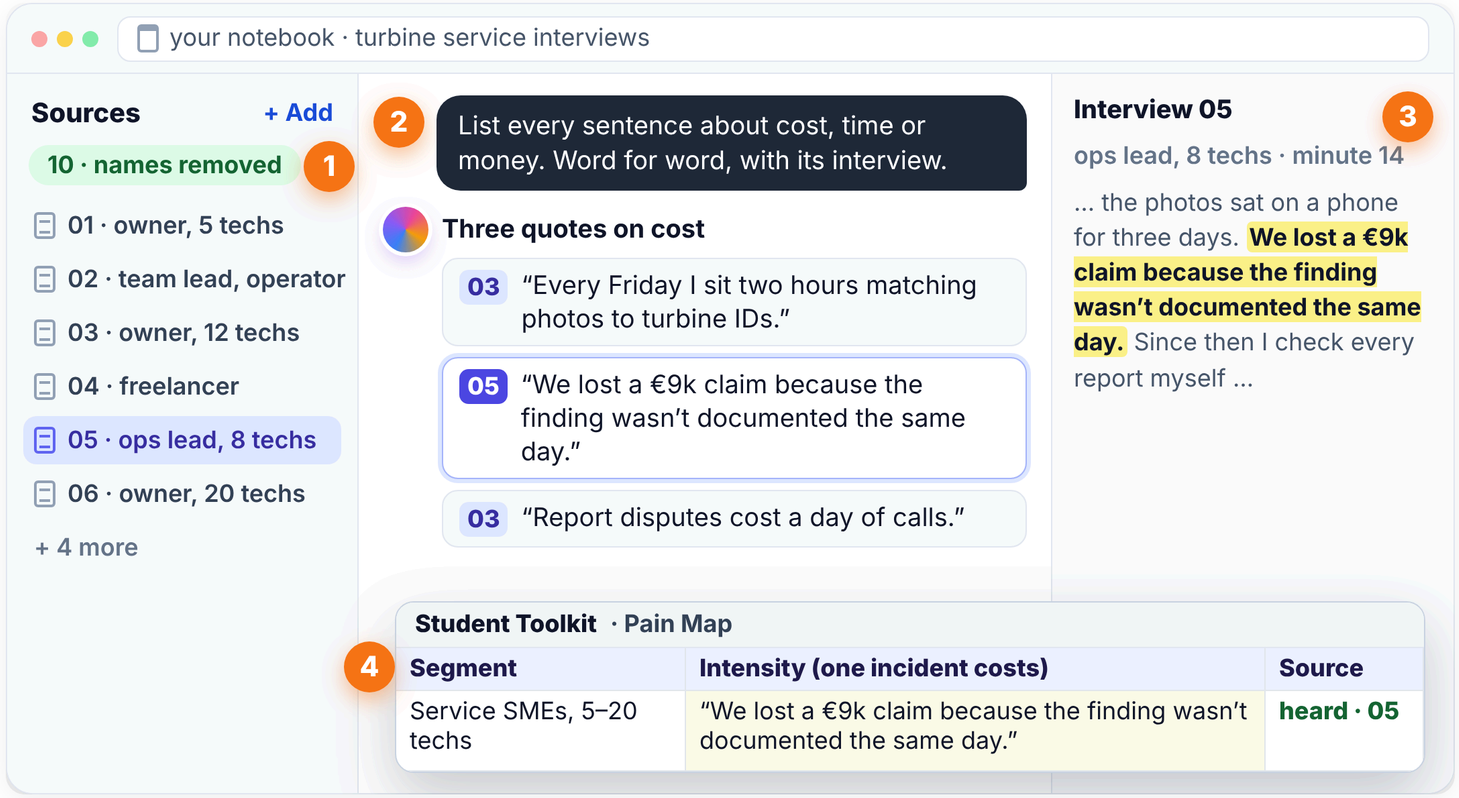
Commit on what you heard



ILLUSTRATIVE Pain Map columns as in the course workshop. Segments and values made up.

HOW-TO · FROM TRANSCRIPTS TO YOUR PAIN MAP

Let a notebook pull out the quotes



1. **Remove names, add transcripts**
2. **Ask for every quote on cost**
3. **Check each quote in its source**
4. **Your agent writes it into your Pain Map, you check**

ILLUSTRATIVE Screen prototyped for this course, quotes made up. NotebookLM is now Gemini Notebook (Google blog, 16 July 2026).

NOW YOU · AS A TEAM · 3 MINUTES

Name your segment and who signs

Who has it worst?

Who signs can say yes to paying?

Heard or assumed?



3:00

OUTPUT

A candidate, not a commitment

INPUT 4 OF 4 · PICK IT · THE ANSWERS

Pick it: it hurts, it's often, they pay

1

What makes a segment worth picking?

It hurts, it happens often, and they can pay

2

Who decides, and who pays?

Not always the same person: the surgeon chooses, the hospital pays

3

What do you base the pick on?

On what you heard, logged in your Pain Map, not what you assumed

CHAPTER 7 OF 9

Wrap-up and check-out

Look back at the cornerstones, reflect on the session and take your bar home.

01 ~~Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship~~

02 ~~Your presentations~~

03 ~~Dig it: the problem behind your idea~~

04 ~~Price it: the job and its workaround~~

05 ~~Hear it: conversations about the last time~~

06 ~~Pick it: the segment with its hair on fire~~

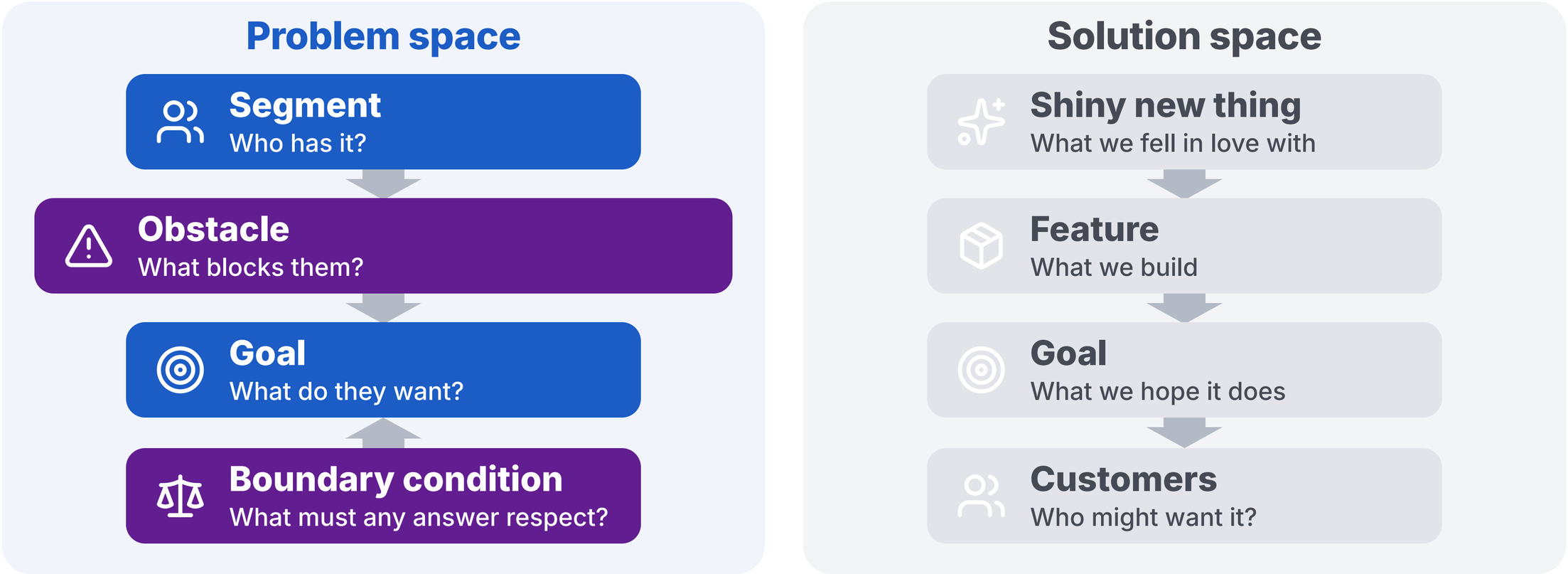
07 **Wrap-up and check-out**

08 Workshop: find the pain worth fixing

09 Case discussion

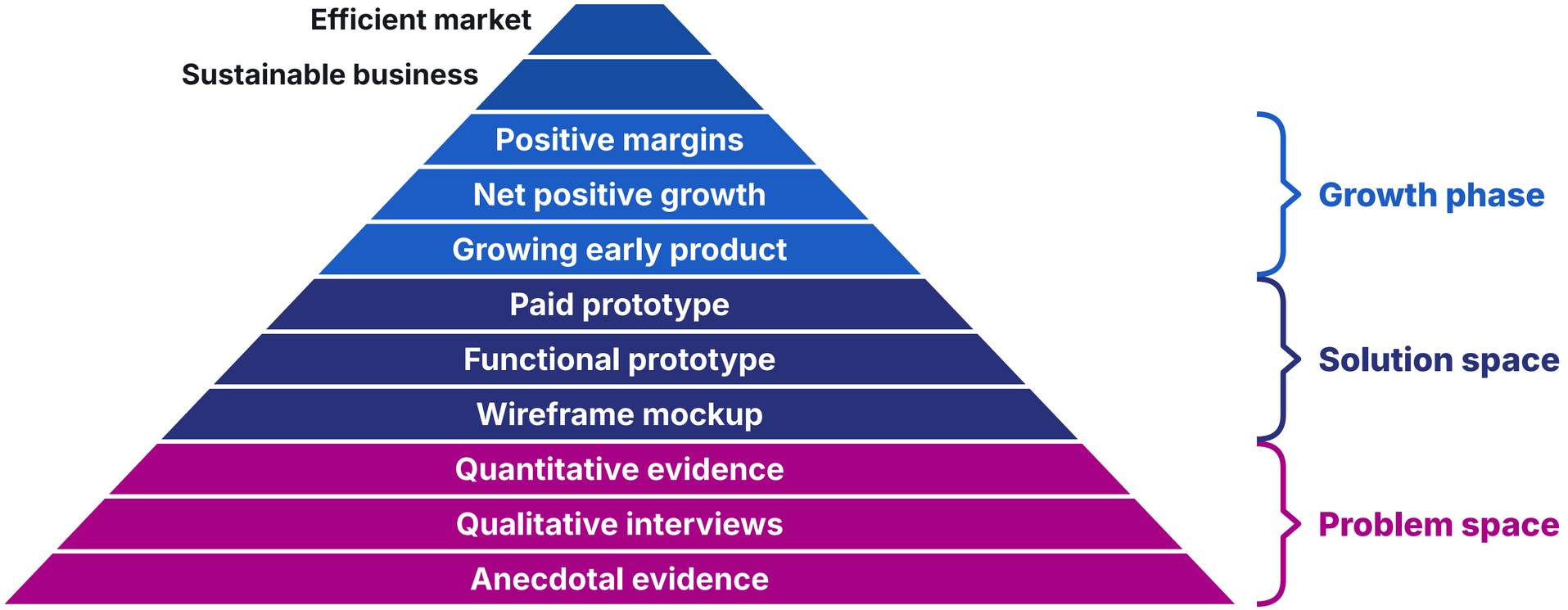
RECAP · CORNERSTONE

Stay left until you hear the cost



RECAP · CORNERSTONE

Evidence gets stronger near money



REFLECTION 1 OF 3 · THE CONTENT

What could you apply?



What could you apply?



What gave you a hard time?

REFLECTION 2 OF 3 · THE PROCESS

Man vs. machine



Where did AI actually help you?



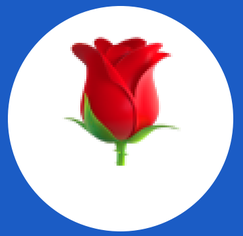
Where was your genius needed?



What are your best hacks to share?

REFLECTION 3 OF 3 · THE RESULTS

Rose, thorn, bud



What was the breakthrough today?



What was the hardest part today?



What is an idea/feature you didn't have time to finish, but want to explore later?

HOMEWORK UNTIL NEXT TIME

Hold 15 problem conversations per student in your hair-on-fire segment and come back with 5 named people per student who agreed to a next step.

15 each

The learning floor is 5 conversations and 2 next steps per student.

Log your kill line in the Toolkit's Kill Criteria Log before your first call.

HOMEWORK · HOW TO DO IT

Seven moves for your 15 conversations

1 **Go where they complain.**

2 **Open on their day.**

Watch out. Name the problem first, and it isn't unprompted.

3 **Never pitch.**

4 **Follow the money.**

5 **End with an ask, like a second call.**

6 **Record with the consent sentence in Legal Basics.**

7 **Get a blind second opinion.**

Watch out. AI personas are rehearsal and never count.

HOMEWORK · WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE

Come back with your first prospects

	Weak	Good
SEGMENT	"Companies"	**Solo HR managers, 50 to 200 staff**
UNPROMPTED	Only when named	**4 of 10**
WORKAROUND	"Annoying"	**5 hours a week, €300 a month**
NEXT STEPS	20 LinkedIn likes	**6 second calls booked**

ILLUSTRATIVE Problem space (M03) homework, what you come back with. A made-up example.

Sources in this deck

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Sheeran, P., & Webb, T. L. (2016). The intention-behavior gap. *Soc. Personal. Psychol. Compass*, 10(9).

Sinsky, C., et al. (2016). Allocation of physician time in ambulatory practice. *Annals of Internal Medicine*, 165(11).

Webb, T. L., & Sheeran, P. (2006). Does changing behavioral intentions engender behavior change? *Psychological Bulletin*, 132(2).

See you next time!

MODULE 03 · WORKSHOP · 90 MINUTES

Workshop: Find the pain worth fixing

Build your Pain Map, hold a real conversation and leave with a week already moving.

Is this a real problem, or just an interesting one?

01 Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship

02 Your presentations

03 **Dig it: the problem behind your idea**

04 **Price it: the job and its workaround**

05 **Hear it: conversations about the last time**

06 **Pick it: the segment with its hair on fire**

07 Wrap-up and check-out

08 **Workshop: find the pain worth fixing**

09 Case discussion

WORKSHOP · STEP 1 OF 3

Define the pain, not the solution

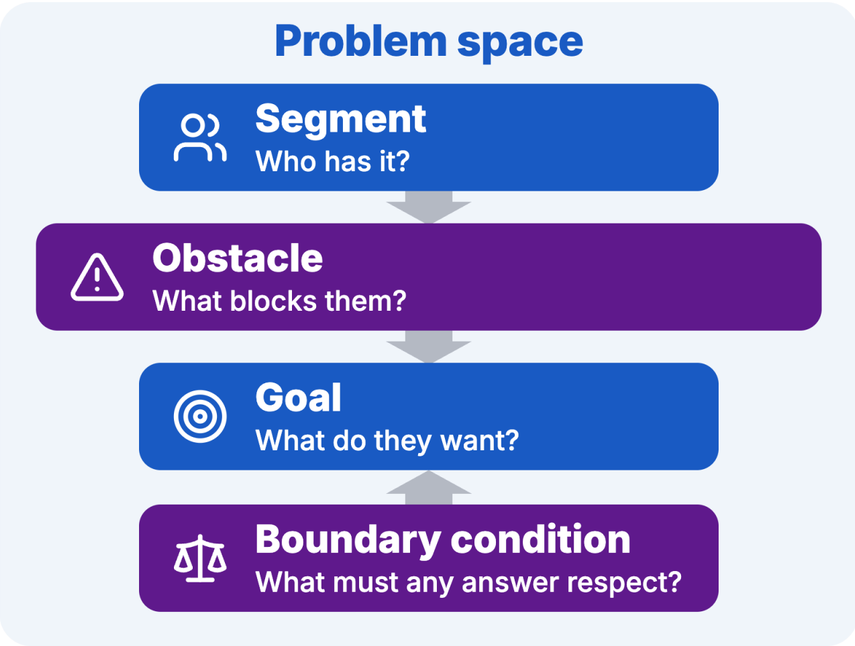
1 STEP 1 · 30 MIN

DEFINE THE PAIN, NOT THE SOLUTION

Agree on who hurts most, when, and at what cost

- → The segment: who suffers most?
- → The trigger: when does it hurt?
- → The fail state: what now, at what cost?
- → Job sentence, obstacle, boundary conditions, Pain Map, each cell heard or assumed
- → Kill line: result, date, consequence, logged before any call

Output Job sentence, Pain Map, hair-on-fire candidate, kill line **Minutes** 30



30:00

WORKSHOP · STEP 2 OF 3

The 5 golden questions, live

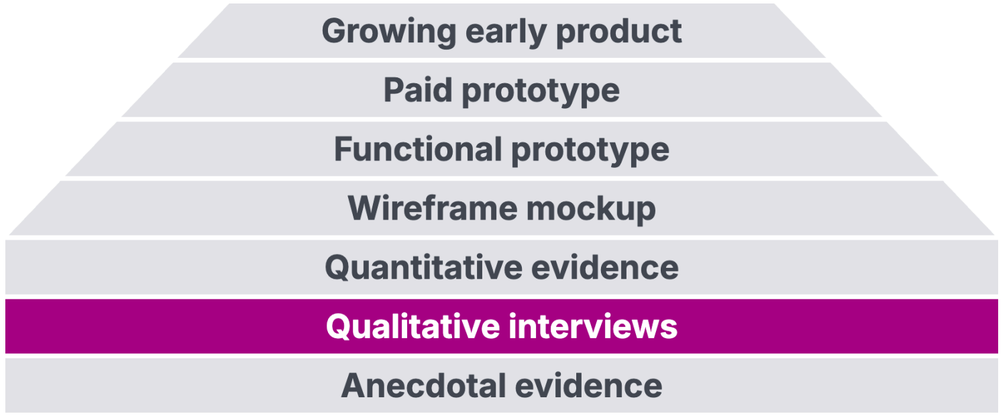
2 STEP 2 · 35 MIN

THE 5 GOLDEN QUESTIONS, LIVE

Is the problem expensive enough to fix? Do NOT pitch.

- → 10 min: open on their day, let them raise it first
- → Last time? Hardest part? Why ×5? Solved how? What don't you love?
- → End with a concrete ask
- → 25 min: one real conversation per team, logged

Output Script with ask, one conversation logged **Minutes** 35



35:00

WORKSHOP · STEP 3 OF 3

Move fast, then commit

3 STEP 3 · 25 MIN

MOVE FAST, THEN COMMIT

Leave with a week that is already moving

- → Deep research and social listening find where they talk
- → Named people, not personas
- → First messages sent before you leave
- → Each student states floor or full bar
- → Midweek day and pace

Output Target list, outreach sent, targets, midweek pace **Minutes** 25



25:00

ARRIVED EMPTY-HANDED?

No interviews yet? Hold two real conversations in Step 2.

2 real conversations

HOMEWORK UNTIL NEXT TIME

Hold 15 problem conversations per student in your hair-on-fire segment and come back with 5 named people per student who agreed to a next step.

15 each

The learning floor is 5 conversations and 2 next steps per student.

Log your kill line in the Toolkit's Kill Criteria Log before your first call.

See you next time!

MODULE 03 · CASE DISCUSSION · ABOUT 90 MINUTES

Case discussion: Konux

Stand in Konux's shoes in October 2016 and choose railway switches or several industries.

Is this a real problem, or just an interesting one?

01 Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship

02 Your presentations

03 **Dig it: the problem behind your idea**

04 **Price it: the job and its workaround**

05 **Hear it: conversations about the last time**

06 **Pick it: the segment with its hair on fire**

07 Wrap-up and check-out

08 Workshop: find the pain worth fixing

09 **Case discussion**

CASE · KONUX, MUNICH, 31 OCTOBER 2016 · VOTE 1 OF 2

Railway switches or several industries?



A
hands



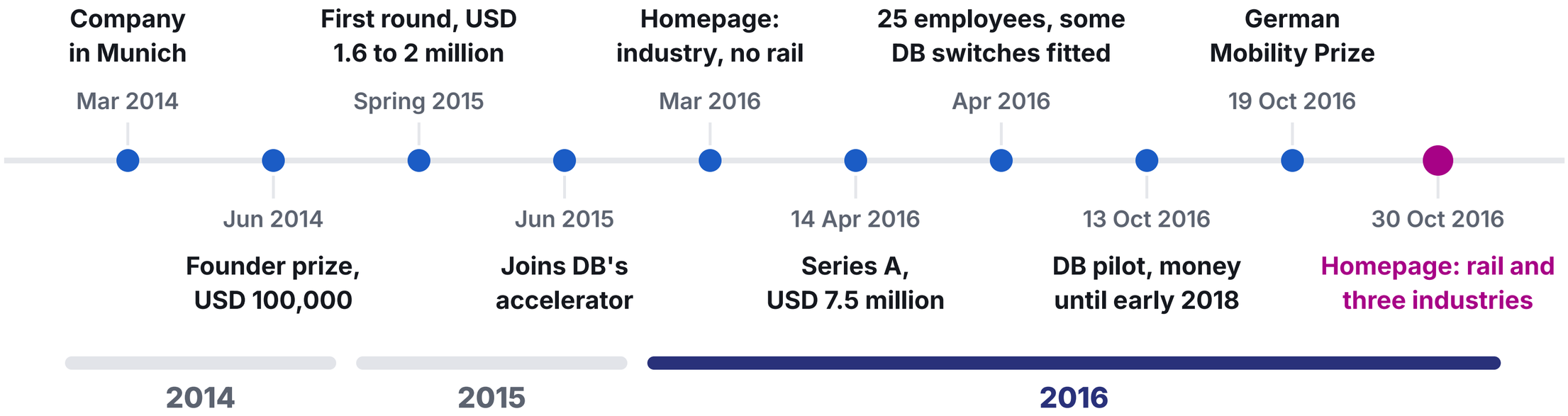
B
hands

Founder prize — **DB accelerator** — **Series A** — **DB pilot** — **31 Oct 2016, you decide**

2014 2015 2016

CASE · WHAT HAPPENED UNTIL 31 OCTOBER 2016

Two and a half years, one decision



DATA Konux case, timeline. Spring 2015: USD 1.6 million (Gründerszene) or 2 million (Hasler, Kunze), as the case reports both.

CASE · EXHIBIT 1

DB Netz switches, 2010 to 2015

	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015
Switches and crossings, DB Netz	71,674	70,477	69,983	69,400	68,516	67,071
Average age of switches, years	19.6	19.6	19.9	20.0	19.9	19.5
Fault reports, all asset groups (priorities 1 to 4)	205,758	195,514	199,953	194,914	183,890	187,338
of which at switches and crossings	**36,338**	**33,025**	**35,555**	**35,854**	**32,152**	**33,108**
Fault duration, all asset groups, minutes (priorities 1 and 2)	8,180,770	7,903,838	8,272,573	9,366,058	9,210,786	9,704,178
of which at switches and crossings	**1,377,288**	**1,309,155**	**1,449,744**	**1,630,366**	**1,604,833**	**1,725,246**
Train delay, all causes, million minutes	159.12	155.48	146.52	164.02	162.43	174.63

DATA Compiled by the case writer from DB Netz AG, Infrastrukturzustands- und -entwicklungsbericht 2014 and 2015 (C37 to C41). Logos are trademarks of their owners.

CASE · DIAGNOSIS · 30 MINUTES

Describe DB's problem without a sensor

Problem space

Segment
Who has it?

Obstacle
What blocks them?

Goal
What do they want?

Boundary condition
What must any answer respect?

Solution space

Shiny new thing
What we fell in love with

Feature
What we build

Goal
What we hope it does

Customers
Who might want it?

CASE · SEGMENT TABLE · 30 MINUTES

Which cells did Konux hear?

	How often	How bad	Spend today	Who signs	Heard or assumed
Rail (DB)					
Industrial pumps					
Machine tools					
Elevators					

CASE · VOTE 2 OF 2

Same question. Who moved, and why?



A
hands



B
hands

Founder prize · **DB accelerator** · **Series A** · **DB pilot** · **31 Oct 2016, you decide**

2014 · 2015 · 2016

CASE · BRIDGE

The empty cells are your next questions

Before your next customer conversation, write your own segment table and mark every cell heard or assumed.

	How often	How bad	Spend today	Who signs	Heard or assumed
Your segment 1					
Your segment 2					
Your segment 3					

See you next time!